

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 444

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to commemorate "FTD Awareness Week,"
September 21-28, 2025, in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the Association for Frontotemporal Degeneration (AFTD) reports that Frontotemporal Degeneration (FTD) is a terminal and incurable neurodegenerative disease affecting the frontal and temporal lobes, causing impairments to speech, personality, behavior, and motor skills, which constitutes a major public health concern; and

WHEREAS, while there has never been a global epidemiology study of FTD, it is estimated that more than 60,000 people are affected in the United States today; and

WHEREAS, AFTD is the leading national organization exclusively focused on the spectrum of FTD disorders with a mission to improve the quality of life for people affected by FTD and drive research to a cure; and

WHEREAS, an accurate diagnosis of FTD takes an average of 3.6 years from the start of symptoms, with an average life expectancy of between seven and thirteen years after the start of symptoms; and

WHEREAS, FTD may strike people between the ages of twenty-one and eighty, with the largest percentage of those affected being between forty-five and sixty-four years of age, rendering people in the prime of life unable to work or function normally; and

WHEREAS, FTD imposes average annual costs associated with care and living with the disease that are approximately double those of Alzheimer's disease; and

WHEREAS, FTD represents an estimated five to fifteen percent of all dementia cases and is the most common form of dementia for people under sixty years of age; and

WHEREAS, approximately forty percent of people with FTD have a family history of FTD or a related condition such as ALS, with about half of those found to have an inherited form accounted for by mutations in the Progranulin, C9orf72, Tau/MAPT, and other rarer genes; and

WHEREAS, FTD is often misdiagnosed as a psychiatric problem or other neurodegenerative disease because of the wide range of cognitive and behavioral symptoms and their onset at an early age; and

WHEREAS, FTD often affects a person's ability to express emotions and to show affection and empathy for loved ones; and

WHEREAS, in the behavioral variant of FTD, a person's sense of social graces and appropriate behavior can be lost, and their personality may be significantly changed; and

WHEREAS, furthermore, in the language variants of FTD (primary progressive aphasia), a person may have trouble producing speech and understanding grammar, lose the meaning of words or become hesitant in speech, and may eventually become mute; and

WHEREAS, in the movement variants of FTD, a person may experience muscle weakness, falling, loss of balance, difficulty making speech, difficulty swallowing, or choking; and

WHEREAS, it is important that we help bring greater awareness of this serious disease to the residents of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commemorate the week of September 21-28, 2025, as "FTD Awareness Week" in the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.